INSTRUCTIONAL AREA
Market Planning

SPORTS AND ENTERTAINMENT MARKETING
TEAM DECISION MAKING EVENT

PARTICIPANT INSTRUCTIONS

(quoted directly from DECA, INC)

- "This event is presented to you through your review of the Career Competencies, Performance Indicators and Event Situation."
- "You have up to 10 minutes to review this information and prepare your presentation. Using the materials provided, you may make notes to use during your presentation."
- "You will have up to 10 minutes to present to the judge(s)."
- "You will be evaluated on your solution to the event situation, how you incorporate the performance indicators of this event and how you demonstrate the career competencies."
- "Turn in all your notes and event materials when you have completed the event."

SOLUTION

- Unique – Demonstrate original thinking, fresh perspectives and an insightful approach.
- Practical – Develop an actionable/viable solution in a real-world context.
- Effective – Develop a solution that achieves relevant outcomes.

CAREER COMPETENCIES

- Critical Thinking – Think critically to understand and solve problems.
- Communication – Communicate clearly, effectively and with reason.
- Decision Making – Consider the impacts of decisions.

PERFORMANCE INDICATORS

1. Explain the role of situation analysis in the marketing planning process.
2. Explain the nature of sales forecasts.
3. Explain the nature of marketing plans.
4. Identify product's/service's competitive advantage.
5. Identify ways to track marketing-communications activities.

EVENT SITUATION

You are to assume the roles of the director of marketing and the marketing coordinator at THE MERIDIAN, a restored 1,400-seat theater from the 1920s that hosts concerts, comedy shows and touring performances. The executive director (judge) wants your team to explain how to plan for next season now that a major competitor is coming to town.

Last season, THE MERIDIAN hosted 96 shows and filled an average of 68% of its seats. A new 15,000-seat arena will open across town next fall. The arena has already announced several major concert tours. The executive director (judge) is worried that fans and performers will choose the arena instead of THE MERIDIAN.

The executive director (judge) also wants to know which marketing efforts are actually selling tickets. Here is how buyers said they heard about last season's shows:

- Email newsletter: 41%
- Social media: 22%
- Walk-up or word of mouth: 15%
- Unknown: 22%

The board of directors wants a marketing plan for next season. The executive director (judge) wants your team to:

- Explain how a situation analysis would help THE MERIDIAN understand where it stands, including the impact of the new arena.
- Explain what a sales forecast is and how THE MERIDIAN could use one for next season.
- Explain what a marketing plan is and what it should include.
- Identify THE MERIDIAN's competitive advantage over the new arena.
- Recommend ways to track which marketing activities are selling tickets.

You will present your ideas to the executive director (judge) in a meeting at the theater. The executive director (judge) will begin the meeting by greeting you and asking to hear your ideas. After you have presented your ideas and answered the executive director's (judge's) questions, the executive director (judge) will conclude the meeting by thanking you for your work.

Possible Judge's Questions:

1. What kind of performers and shows should we focus on booking now that the arena is opening?
2. How can we forecast sales for next season when we've never competed against an arena before?

Rate the participants' ability to:		Novice	Developing	Proficient	Exemplary	Judged Score
PERFORMANCE INDICATORS						
1.	Explain the role of situation analysis in the marketing planning process.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
2.	Explain the nature of sales forecasts.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
3.	Explain the nature of marketing plans.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
4.	Identify product's/service's competitive advantage.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
5.	Identify ways to track marketing-communications activities.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
SOLUTION						
6.	**Unique** Demonstrate original thinking, fresh perspectives and an insightful approach.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
7.	**Practical** Develop an actionable/viable solution in a real-world context.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
8.	**Effective** Develop a solution that achieves relevant outcomes	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
CAEREER COMPETANCIES						
9.	**Critical Thinking** Think critically to understand and solve problems	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
10.	**Communication** Communicate clearly, effectively and with reason.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
11.	**Decision Making** Consider the impacts of decisions.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
OVERALL IMPRESSIONS						
12.	Demonstrate overall career readiness through professionalism, poise and confidence.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
					TOTAL SCORE	